PRD: AICTE EoA Verification Workflow & Automation (PS 26262)

Oct 26, 2026 · @siriyas

1. Overview and scope

This PRD defines the first module of Problem Statement 26262: a platform that routes, verifies and monitors Extension of Approval (EoA) applications from existing institutions under APH 2024-27, Chapter II. The undertaking and lease-validity modules in the problem statement come later, and this design leaves room for them.

In scope (this PRD)

- Receiving submitted EoA applications and checking they are ready to process (cut-off, TER paid, eligibility blocks).
- Automatic routing by application category, using Tables 2.2 and 2.3 of the APH.
- Stage handling for Scrutiny / Re-Scrutiny, Expert Visit Committee (EVC), Standing Hearing Committee (SHC), Executive Committee, appeal to the Standing Appellate Committee (SAC) and final grant.
- Deficiency, return/revert, one-time reopening, withdrawal and fallback-to-EoA handling.
- Pendency and ageing monitoring, deadline alerts, escalation, role-based dashboards and reports.
- Post-grant deadlines that belong to the EoA itself: Security Deposit proof (15 days) and its penalty dates.
- A complete, tamper-evident audit trail.

Out of scope (this PRD)

- Chapter I (new institutions) and Chapters III onward, except where Chapter II refers to them.
- Any decision, scrutiny finding or inspection outcome. The system supports these; competent authorities make them.
- Building the AICTE web portal, payment gateway or application forms. We integrate with them.
- The full time-bound undertaking tracker and lease/document validity monitor (problem statement sections D and E). Phase 2.

Lease rule carried in this module. Clause 2.1(e) stops EoA once the live lease equals the longest course duration, unless the lease is extended by 30 years. We therefore compute and flag remaining lease years during verification, but continuous lease monitoring stays in Phase 2.

2. Background, problem and goals

Every year, existing institutions apply online for EoA, and each application then moves through a different mix of stages depending on its category. Today, tracking where an application sits, who owes the next action and how long it has waited depends on manual follow-up across Regions and committees.

Problems to solve

- The route for each category (Table 2.3) is applied by hand, so applications can be sent to the wrong stage or stall between stages.
- Pendency, EVC scheduling and appeal clocks (for example, 7 days to appeal) are watched manually, so deadlines slip.
- Deficiency, return and reopening decisions are scattered, and the reasons are not always recorded in one place.
- Officers and institutions lack one shared view of status, so they repeat follow-up calls and emails.

Goals

1. Route every application to the correct stages automatically and move it forward when a stage completes.
2. Show real-time status, ageing and workload by Region, stage, institution and officer.
3. Alert and escalate before and after every deadline, with no missed clock.
4. Record every action, reason and decision in an audit trail that can be traced end to end.
5. Keep human authorities in control of every verification and decision.

Non-goals

- Auto-approving or auto-rejecting any application.
- Replacing committee judgement, inspection or the Speaking Order.

3. Users, roles and permissions

Access is role-based and scoped by Region. No role can edit a committee's finding or decision once it is recorded; corrections are new, logged entries.

Role	Main tasks in the system	Can decide?
Institution (Director / Principal / authorised signatory)	Track own application, upload compliance, receive alerts, view speaking orders, file appeal	No
Scrutiny / Re-Scrutiny Committee member	Verify documents against checklist, record deficiencies, mark outcome	Yes, as per APH (recommendation)
EVC expert	Accept visit, upload report, record findings	Yes, as per APH (recommendation)
Standing Hearing Committee (SHC)	Review compliance, record recommendation	Yes, as per APH (recommendation)
Executive Committee	Review consolidated list, take decision, upload Speaking Order	Yes (decision)
Standing Appellate Committee (SAC) / Council	Hear appeal, record recommendation / final decision	Yes (final)
Regional officer	Monitor Region pendency, assign and reassign work, handle first escalation	Workflow actions only
Regulation Bureau officer	Monitor all Regions, consolidated list for grant, second escalation	Workflow actions only
Policy and Academic Planning Bureau	Hearing of unapproved-institution representations (clause 2.26e)	As per APH
System administrator	Configure rules, calendars, templates and users	No
Auditor (read-only)	View audit trail and reports	No

Rules for access

- A user sees only the Regions, stages and applications their role allows.
- Committee members cannot see applications where they declare a conflict of interest.
- Institutions see only their own application, alerts and orders.

- Every view of a sensitive document is logged.

4. Application categories and routing matrix

Every application falls into one of four routes. The route is configuration, not code, so AICTE can change it when the APH changes.

- **SD:** Self-Disclosure only. The system generates the Nil Deficiency report; no scrutiny stage.
- **SCR:** Scrutiny / Re-Scrutiny only.
- **SCR+EVC:** Scrutiny, then EVC.
- **SCR+EVC+AA:** Scrutiny, EVC, then SAC/SHC only if the earlier outcome has deficiencies ("AA" = as applicable).

The table below is copied from Table 2.3 (stages) and Table 2.2 (window). "Public Notice" means submission and processing follow the dates in the AICTE Public Notice; "Year round" means they are open all year.

Application category	Route	Window
EoA based on Self-Disclosure	SD	Public Notice
Introduction / Continuation of NRI seats	SD	Public Notice
Conversion of Diploma Level into Degree Level and vice-versa	SCR+EVC+AA	Public Notice
Change in Name of Institution / affiliating University or Board / Type of Institution (except converted into a University)	SCR	Public Notice
To start new Programme / Level	SCR+EVC+AA	Public Notice
Merger of Institutions (same / different Trust, Society, Company; same campus or city)	SCR+EVC+AA	Public Notice
EoA after break in preceding Academic Year / Restoration of Intake / Hibernation	SCR+EVC+AA	Public Notice

Application category	Route	Window
Introduction / Continuation of seats for Foreign Nationals, OCI, Children of Indian Workers in Gulf Countries	SCR (EVC not applicable)	Public Notice
Increase in Intake / Additional Course(s)	SCR+EVC+AA	Public Notice
Introduction of Integrated / Dual Degree Course	SCR+EVC+AA	Public Notice
Introduction / Continuation of Fellow Programme in Management	SCR+EVC+AA	Public Notice
Change in Name of Course / Merger of Courses / Reduction in Intake	SCR	Public Notice
Introduction / Continuation of Collaboration and Twinning Programme	SCR+EVC+AA	Public Notice
Change of Site / Location	SCR+EVC+AA	Year round
Closure of the Institution	SCR	Year round
Conversion of Women's Institution into Co-ed and vice-versa	SCR	Year round
Closure of Programme(s) / Course(s)	SCR	Year round
Change in Bank Details	SCR	Year round
Change in Name of Trust / Society / Company	SCR	Year round
Type of Institution converted into a Deemed-to-be-University	SCR+EVC+AA	Year round
Online Learning / ODL courses	SCR+EVC+AA	Year round (processed twice a year per UGC timeline)

Routing rules the engine must apply

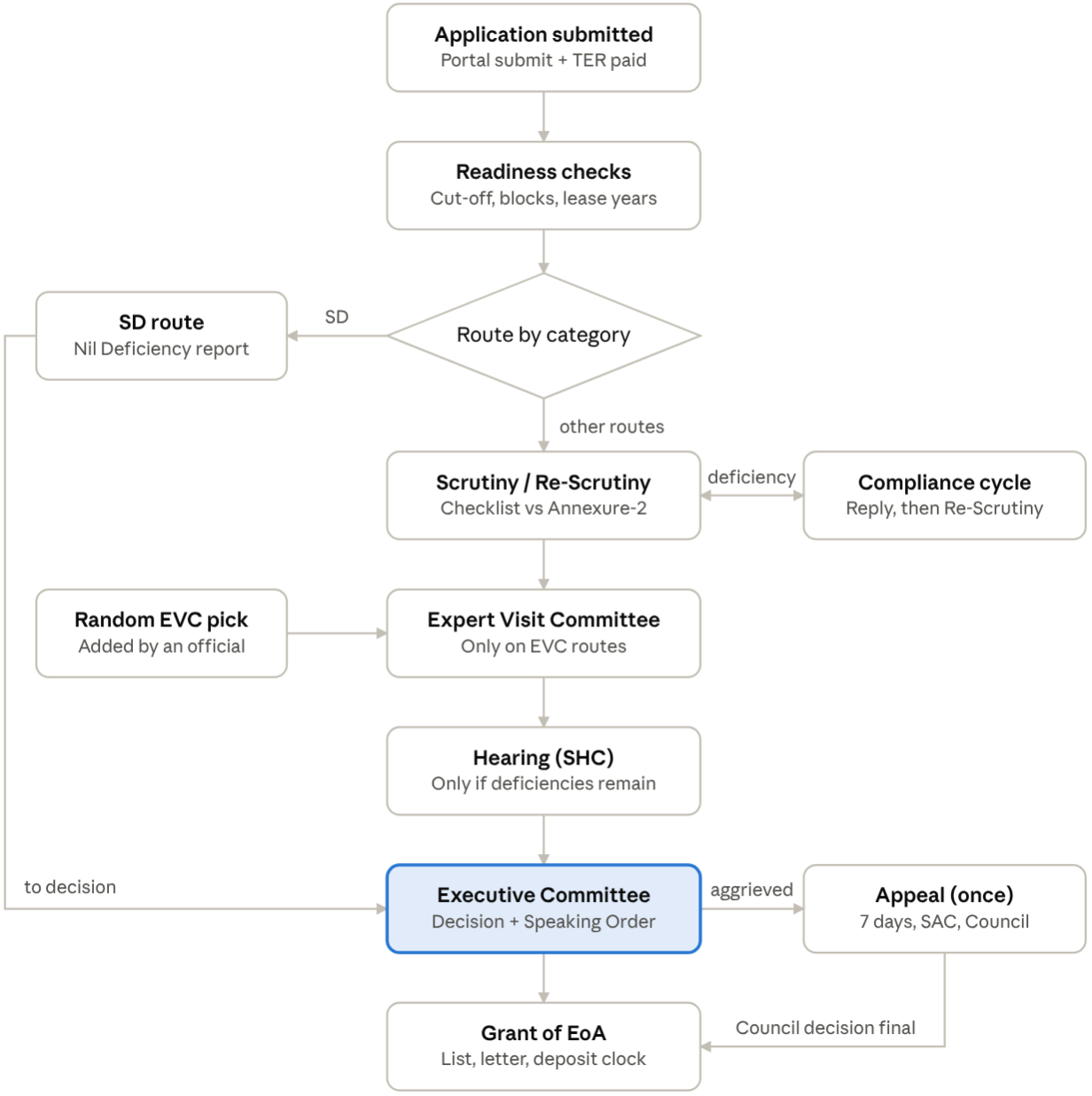
1. **Random EVC.** Clause 2.3.5 lets AICTE select institutions at random for an EVC, so an SD application can be pulled into an EVC queue by an authorised user.
2. **Combined applications.** One institution may apply for several categories together (for example, EoA plus a new programme). The route is the union of the stages needed, and the outcome is recorded per category.
3. **Fallback to EoA.** If a new programme, level conversion, Women's-to-Co-ed conversion or similar request is not approved, EoA for the existing institution is issued instead (clauses 2.7l, 2.14j, 2.15e), provided EoA requirements are met. The engine opens this branch automatically after a "not approved" decision.
4. **Women's Institution merger.** If any merging institution is a Women's Institution, the Women's-to-Co-ed conversion is processed first and the merger only after it clears (clause 2.13.1m).
5. **Change of Site.** After the movable property is shifted, a second EVC may be needed before the session starts (clause 2.17e).
6. **Increase in intake.** An EVC must confirm infrastructure and faculty before intake is approved (clause 2.6).
7. **Cut-off.** An application submitted after the Public Notice cut-off is not processed this Academic Year and is queued for the next one.

Gaps in the source tables to confirm with AICTE (see Section 11): Introduction of Off-Campus (clause 2.11e says it is processed like a New Technical Institution) and Extended EoA appear in the text or Table 2.2 but have no row in Table 2.3.

5. End-to-end workflow and stages

Each application passes the stages its category requires and moves to the next one automatically when an authorised user marks the current stage complete.

Each application follows its Table 2.3 route; people decide at every gate



workflow · 8 stages, 1 route decision

The SD branch skips scrutiny and goes straight to the decision list. The EVC and hearing boxes are skipped when the route or the outcome does not need them. A deficiency sends the application to the institution and back to Re-Scrutiny. The highlighted Executive Committee decision is taken by people, never by the system. Return / revert and withdrawal can happen at any stage with a recorded reason, and a "not approved" outcome opens the fallback EoA branch where the APH allows it.

Stage definitions

Stage	Owner	Starts when	Completes when
Readiness checks	System; Regional officer clears flags	Final submission and TER payment are received	All checks pass, or an official clears or holds each flag
Routing	System	Readiness checks complete	Route and stage list are recorded for each category
Scrutiny / Re-Scrutiny	Scrutiny committee	Application is assigned	Result recorded as Nil Deficiency, or a deficiency report is issued
Compliance cycle	Institution, then scrutiny committee	Deficiency report is issued	Institution replies and the Re-Scrutiny result is recorded
Expert Visit Committee	EVC coordinator and experts	Scrutiny is done and the route needs an EVC, or an official adds it at random	Visit is held and the report is uploaded
Hearing (SHC)	Standing Hearing Committee	A deficiency remains after scrutiny or EVC	Compliance is heard and the recommendation is recorded
Executive Committee decision	Executive Committee	Recommendation or Nil Deficiency list is ready	Decision and Speaking Order are uploaded
Appeal	Institution, SAC, Council	Decision is uploaded; 7-day window opens	Window lapses, or the Council records its final decision
Grant	Regulation Bureau, Executive Committee / Council	Decisions are final	List is ratified, letter is published, Security Deposit clock starts

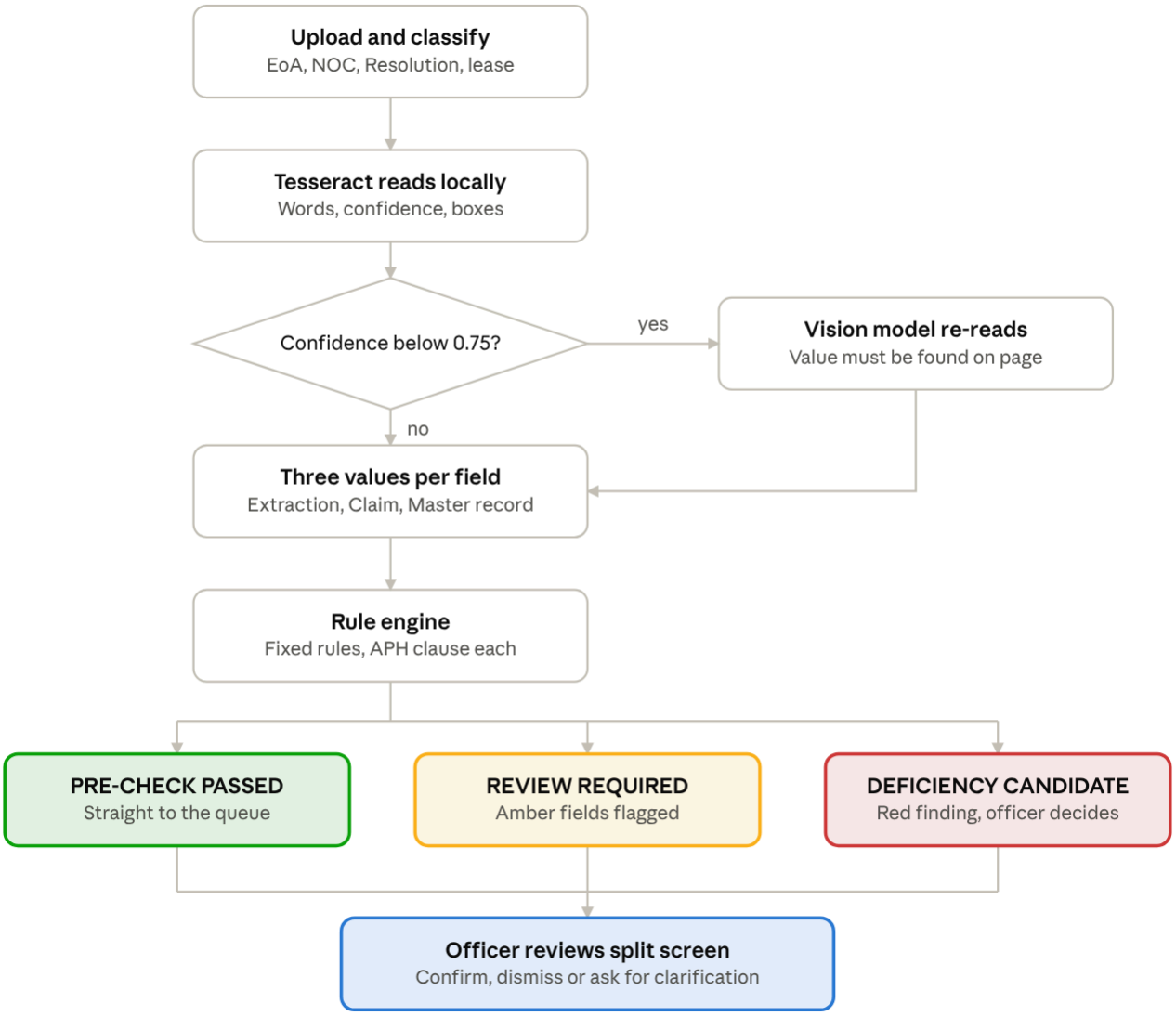
5.5 Document intelligence and AI pre-check

Before a committee opens a file, the system reads every uploaded document, compares it with AICTE's own record and the APH clause, and hands the officer a marked-up evidence report. The AI layer extracts and flags. It never approves, rejects or returns an application.

How it works

1. **Ingest.** The institution uploads documents (PDF, scan or DOCX). The system classifies each one: AICTE EoA letter (master record), Format-2 NOC, Format-3 Resolution, lease, affidavit or another Annexure-2 item.
2. **Extract (hybrid OCR).** Tesseract runs locally and returns every word with a confidence score and a bounding box. Any page or field below the confidence threshold (default 0.75, configurable) is re-read by a vision model through OpenRouter, which returns structured JSON. The model name is configuration; Gemini Flash is the first choice.
3. **Ground.** A value returned by the vision model counts only if its text can be found on the page (fuzzy match to the OCR words). A value that cannot be found is marked REVIEW_REQUIRED, so the model cannot invent a field.
4. **Compare.** The rule engine checks the extracted values against AICTE's record and the APH clause. Rules are fixed, versioned code, not model opinion.
5. **Classify.** The application gets one of three outcomes (below).
6. **Present.** The officer opens a split-screen review with the evidence highlighted on the original document.

The AI layer reads and flags; the officer decides



AI pre-check · 6 steps, 3 outcomes

All three outcomes reach the officer. The system flags and shows evidence; only the officer records a disposition.

The three-value model

Every extracted field keeps three values, so a silent edit can never hide.

Value	What it is	Comes from	Example
Extraction Value	What the document actually says	OCR / vision model	Survey No. 42/3

Value	What it is	Comes from	Example
Claim Value	What the institution confirms or edits in the form after seeing the auto-fill	Institution	Survey No. 42/2
Master Record Value	What AICTE's own record says	EoA letter / portal	Survey No. 42/2

- The form is auto-filled with the Extraction Value. If the institution changes it, the field is marked REVIEW_REQUIRED, both values are kept, and the institution must give a reason. The wording is neutral ("edited after extraction") because OCR can be wrong and an edit can be honest.
- **Rules run on the Extraction Value, never on the Claim Value.** In the example, the institution edits 42/3 to 42/2 to match the EoA. The edit is flagged, and the address rule still fails because the NOC itself says 42/3. An edit cannot clear a failed rule.

Rule engine

Each rule has an ID, a clause reference and a severity, held in a rule registry that administrators maintain. The clause text shown to the officer comes from this registry, never from a model.

Rule	Check	APH clause	If it fails
RULE-DOC-01	Required documents are present and DSC-signed; Affidavit 2 is present	2.3.4a, b	Deficiency candidate
RULE-E01	Trust / Society / Company name on the NOC equals the name on the EoA	Annexure-2 (exact item to confirm)	Deficiency candidate
RULE-E02	Old address and survey number on the NOC equal the current address on the EoA	Annexure-2 (exact item to confirm)	Deficiency candidate
RULE-E03	Institution name, PID and type agree across all documents	Annexure-2	Deficiency candidate
RULE-SITE-01	The Format-3 Resolution covers all approved programmes and does not describe partial shifting	2.17i	Deficiency candidate

Rule	Check	APH clause	If it fails
RULE-SITE-02	The new address lies inside the jurisdiction of the current affiliating University (not applied to PGDM institutions)	2.17b	Deficiency candidate
RULE-LEASE-01	Remaining lease years exceed the longest course duration, or a 30-year extension is on file	2.1e	Deficiency candidate
RULE-OCR-01	A field was read below the confidence threshold, or the fallback value was not found on the page	None	Review required
RULE-EDIT-01	Claim Value differs from Extraction Value	None	Review required

RULE-SITE-01 uses two checks together: a keyword and phrase list for wording such as "only" next to a department name, and a comparison of the programmes named in the resolution with the programmes on the EoA. Neither check is final; the officer decides.

Three outcomes

Outcome	When	Institution sees	System does
PRE-CHECK PASSED	All rules pass, all fields grounded, none edited	Green confirmation	Sends the file to the Scrutiny queue with the report attached
REVIEW REQUIRED	Low confidence, ungrounded value or edited field	A request for a reason for each edit	Sends the file to the queue with amber fields at the top of the report
DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE	A deterministic rule failed	A warning before final submission, with the finding and clause	Sends the file to the queue with red findings; the officer must confirm or dismiss each

No outcome rejects an application or stops a submission. After final submission the portal locks the data (clause 2.3.3c), so the pre-check warns the institution beforehand and always passes the evidence to the officer. **Gate:** the Scrutiny stage cannot be marked

complete until the officer has recorded a disposition for every amber and red finding: Confirmed as deficiency, Dismissed with reason, or Clarification requested.

Split-screen reviewer

- **Left: the form.** Each field shows its Claim Value. An edited field carries a badge: "Institution edited AI extraction", with the original value one click away.
- **Right: the original document.** Clicking a field draws a highlight box on the exact words, using the stored bounding box. Where the vision model supplied a value, the system finds the words on the page by fuzzy match; if none is found it shows the page without a box and says so.
- **Below: the findings report.** Each finding lists the rule ID, the clause from the registry, the values compared, the page, the evidence snippet, and the officer's buttons.
- Every officer action on a finding goes to the audit trail.

Data kept for each extracted field

Value, page, bounding box, confidence, engine (Tesseract or model name and version), grounding result, Claim Value, edit reason, and the officer's disposition. Together with the document hash, this lets anyone replay how a finding was reached.

Limits and risks of the AI layer

- **Poor scans and handwriting** lower confidence and create more amber flags. They must never create a false pass. Extraction accuracy is measured on a labelled test set before each release.
- **Keyword checks miss paraphrases.** That is why RULE-SITE-01 also compares programme lists, and why the officer reviews the evidence.
- **External model calls send page images outside the system.** A switch turns the fallback off, only low-confidence pages are sent, and each call is logged. A production deployment should use a model approved by AICTE or hosted on its own infrastructure. The prototype uses only public or synthetic documents.
- **Model drift.** The model is used only for reading, at temperature zero, with output checked against a JSON schema; its name and version are stored with every result.
- **Jurisdiction data.** RULE-SITE-02 needs a list of which districts or cities fall under each University. This must come from AICTE or the Universities.

Open questions raised by this layer

1. Can the system read the institution's EoA letter and affiliating University from the portal as structured data, or only as a PDF?

2. Are official templates available for Format-2 NOC and Format-3 Resolution, and which Annexure-2 item lists the NOC fields?
3. Is any external model service allowed for institution documents, or must all reading stay inside AICTE infrastructure?
4. Who supplies and maintains the University jurisdiction table?

6. Functional requirements

P0 = needed for the prototype demo and first release. P1 = next release. "APH" refers to the clause of the Approval Process Handbook 2024-27.

A. Intake and readiness checks

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-01	Receive each final-submitted application from the AICTE portal with its unique application ID, PID, category, institution type, submission time, TER payment status and uploaded documents.	2.3.1	P0
FR-02	Reject from processing, and tag for the next Academic Year, any application submitted or paid after the Public Notice cut-off.	2.2, 2.22	P0
FR-03	Flag applications that are blocked by a rule: Closure applicants applying for other categories; no EoA for six consecutive years; standalone PGDM/PGCM without full student data; intake increase while a Central/State inquiry is pending; partial approval of programmes.	2.21f, 2.16.1a, 2.3.1, 2.6e, 2.27	P0
FR-04	Record which of the six 3-year EoA criteria (NIRF, QS Asia, NBA 30%, NAAC 3.01+, Autonomy, 80% admission for 5 years) the institution claims, and give the verifier a checklist to confirm it.	2.1a	P1
FR-05	Compute remaining lease years against the longest course duration and flag when the live lease equals it, unless a 30-year extension is on file.	2.1e	P0

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-06	Confirm Affidavit 2 and DSC-signed documents (Annexure-2) are present; list missing items as a deficiency draft.	2.3.4	P0

B. Routing

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-07	Assign the route (SD, SCR, SCR+EVC, SCR+EVC+AA) from the category using a configurable routing table.	Table 2.3	P0
FR-08	Support combined applications and per-category outcomes; apply sequencing rules (for example, Women's conversion before merger).	2.13.1m	P0
FR-09	Move the application to the next stage automatically when the current stage is marked complete by an authorised user.	PS A	P0
FR-10	Open SAC/SHC only when an earlier stage records deficiencies or a negative outcome ("AA").	Table 2.3	P0
FR-11	After a "not approved" outcome, open the fallback EoA branch where the APH provides it.	2.7l, 2.14j, 2.15e	P0

C. Scrutiny / Re-Scrutiny

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-12	Assign the application to a committee or member by Region and workload, with a conflict-of-interest declaration.	1.8	P0
FR-13	Generate a verification checklist from the category's Annexure-2 document list and show each uploaded document beside it.	Annexure-2	P0
FR-14	Record a result per checklist item and an overall result: Nil Deficiency or Deficiency, with remarks.	2.4	P0

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-15	Produce a deficiency report and open a compliance window for the institution; accept compliance uploads and send them to Re-Scrutiny.	2.3.3b, 2.4	P0
FR-16	Store the reference of the recording of each scrutiny session.	2.28	P1
FR-17	Pre-fill an electronic case summary and draft communications for the committee to review and edit.	PS A	P1

D. Expert Visit Committee (EVC)

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-18	Place the application in the EVC queue once scrutiny is complete, when the route needs an EVC.	2.23.2	P0
FR-19	Allow an authorised user to add an application to the EVC queue at random, and to schedule a second EVC after a site shift.	2.3.5, 2.17e	P0
FR-20	Schedule an EVC as online or physical, assign experts, record confirmation, and show a calendar by Region.	1.9	P0
FR-21	Block scheduling of an additional EVC until the additional TER payment is confirmed (Rs 1.25 lakh online, Rs 2.50 lakh physical; Rs 0.25 / 0.50 lakh for Government).	2.3.2c	P1
FR-22	Collect the EVC report and findings, and route a deficiency outcome to SHC. Flag any finding of fraudulent documents for referral to the competent authority.	2.3.5b	P0
FR-23	Track EVCs required after approval (for example, for new courses before the first batch passes out).	2.6j	P1

E. Hearing, decision and appeal

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-24	Schedule SHC, record institutional compliance, and place the recommendation before the Executive Committee.	2.23.3	P0
FR-25	Block an additional Scrutiny / SHC / SAC until the additional fee is paid (Rs 0.60 lakh; Rs 0.15 lakh for Government).	2.3.2b	P1
FR-26	Record the Executive Committee decision and the uploaded Speaking Order.	2.23.3, 2.25c	P0
FR-27	Start a 7-day appeal clock when the decision is uploaded; allow one appeal only; schedule SAC; record the Council's final decision.	2.24	P0

F. Return, reopening and withdrawal

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-28	Let an authorised official return or revert an application to a prior stage or to the institution. A reason code and free-text reason are mandatory.	PS A	P0
FR-29	Allow a one-time reopening, only with Competent Authority approval, and require TER plus late-submission penalty before it resumes.	2.3.3e	P0
FR-30	Handle withdrawal or revocation: within 7 days of the last date (refund minus Rs 0.25 lakh); closure revocation by 10 April; resolution in Format 3 attached.	2.3.3d,f,g	P1

G. Grant and post-grant deadlines

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-31	Build the consolidated list of institutions with Approved Intake for the Executive Committee / Council and record ratification.	2.25a	P0

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-32	Publish the EoA letter and Approved Intake to the institution login. Do not issue any EoA after the last date in the Academic Calendar.	2.25b, j	P0
FR-33	Where a Security Deposit applies, start a 15-day clock for payment proof and Affidavit 3; add 10% penalty up to 31 May and 20% up to 31 July; flag withdrawal after that.	2.25d-f	P0
FR-34	Remind institutions to upload student enrolment before 30 November.	2.25n	P1
FR-35	Where the affiliating University or Board must give views, track the 15-day window and proceed automatically when none arrives.	2.19c	P1

H. Configuration

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-36	Provide an admin console for routes, stage owners, timelines, fee amounts, calendars, alert templates and escalation chains, with a version history.	PS Key Req.	P0
FR-37	Load each year's Public Notice dates and Academic Calendar and apply them to all clocks.	2.2, 2.25	P0

I. Document intelligence and AI pre-check

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-38	Accept PDF, scanned image and DOCX uploads and classify each as EoA letter, Format-2 NOC, Format-3 Resolution, lease, affidavit or other Annexure-2 item.	2.3.4, Annexure-2	P0
FR-39	Extract text with Tesseract, storing each word's confidence and bounding box. Re-read pages or fields below the threshold (default 0.75) with a vision model through OpenRouter; model and threshold are configuration.	Section 5.5	P0

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-40	Accept a vision-model value only if its text is found on the page; otherwise mark it REVIEW_REQUIRED.	Section 5.5	P0
FR-41	Keep Extraction, Claim and Master Record values for every field. If the institution edits an extracted value, mark it REVIEW_REQUIRED, keep both values and require a reason.	Section 5.5	P0
FR-42	Cross-check the Format-2 NOC against the EoA master record: Trust / Society / Company name, old address and survey number, institution name, PID and type. Run rules on the Extraction Value.	Annexure-2	P0
FR-43	Check that the proposed new site lies within the jurisdiction of the current affiliating University, except for PGDM institutions.	2.17b	P0
FR-44	Read the Format-3 Resolution and raise a finding if it names only some programmes or describes partial shifting.	2.17i	P0
FR-45	Read the lease end date, compute remaining years against the longest course duration, and raise a finding when they are equal or the lease is shorter. Store the end date for expiry alerts.	2.1e	P0
FR-46	Assign PRE-CHECK PASSED, REVIEW REQUIRED or DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE. No outcome rejects, returns or blocks an application.	PS Regulatory Safeguard	P0
FR-47	Do not allow the Scrutiny stage to be marked complete until the officer has recorded a disposition (Confirmed, Dismissed with reason, Clarification requested) for every amber and red finding.	2.4	P0
FR-48	Show a split-screen review: form with edit badges on the left, original document on the right with a highlight box on the evidence, and a findings report below.	Section 5.5	P0

ID	Requirement	APH	Priority
FR-49	Warn the institution of findings before final submission, with the rule, clause and values compared.	2.3.3	P1
FR-50	Keep a rule registry (ID, clause, APH edition, severity, on / off, version) editable by administrators, with the change logged.	PS Key Req.	P1
FR-51	Provide a switch to turn the external model fallback off, send only low-confidence pages, and log each external call.	PS Key Req. (confidentiality)	P1

7. Business rules and configurable parameters

Every value below is stored as configuration with an effective date, so a change in the APH needs an admin edit, not a code release. Source: APH 2024-27, Chapter II.

Time limits and clocks

Rule	Value	APH
Appeal to Council against Executive Committee decision	Once, within 7 days of the decision being uploaded	2.24a
Revocation of a submitted application (other than EoA)	Within 7 days of the last date; refund after deduction of Rs 0.25 lakh	2.3.3f
Withdrawal of a pending Closure application	On or before 10 April of the calendar year	2.3.3g
Reopening of a submitted application	One time only, with Competent Authority approval, with TER and late penalty	2.3.3e
Security Deposit proof and Affidavit 3	Within 15 days of intimation; 10% penalty up to 31 May; 20% up to 31 July; approval withdrawn after that	2.25f
Affiliating University / Board views on name or type change	Within 15 days of the last submission date	2.19c
Student enrolment upload	Before 30 November	2.25n

Rule	Value	APH
Restoration after punitive action	Apply in the next Academic Year and within 6 years	2.16.2a
Break in EoA	No EoA application for 6 consecutive years means apply as a new institution	2.16.1a
Hibernation period	One year less than the longest course duration at the institution (for example, 3 years for UG Engineering)	2.16.1d
Closure application validity	For the duration of the course / programme	2.18f, 2.21h
Submission and processing windows	Per Public Notice (Category 1) or year round (Category 2)	Table 2.2

Processing timelines that the APH does not state

The pasted text gives no number of days for Scrutiny, EVC scheduling, SHC or Executive Committee action. These are configurable and AICTE must supply them (see Section 11). The prototype uses clearly labelled placeholder values.

TER charges (Rs lakh) — Table 2.1

Charges rise 10% each year (note i). Charges are not refunded if an application is processed and rejected (note iii). Change in Bank Details costs Rs 0.06 lakh (Rs 6,000). Closure of the institution has no TER charge. Charges for EoA based on Self-Disclosure and continuation of OCI / FN / Gulf-worker seats are applied per Division and per Course; all others are charged irrespective of the number of Divisions or Courses.

EoA, intake and seat-related charges

Charge head	Government / Central University / State University	All other institutions (incl. Govt Aided and Minority)
EoA on Self-Disclosure, per Division: all programmes except PGDM/MBA	0.05	0.20
EoA on Self-Disclosure, per Division: PGDM/MBA	0.15	0.40
EoA on Self-Disclosure: vocational courses	Nil	Nil

Charge head	Government / Central University / State University	All other institutions (incl. Govt Aided and Minority)
Penalty for late submission	0.25	2.50
Break in EoA / Restoration of Intake	0.50	2.50
Introduction of OCI / FN / Gulf-worker seats / Off-Campus	0.50	6.00
Continuation of OCI / FN / Gulf-worker seats, per Course	0.05	0.30
Introduction of Fellow Programme in Management	0.50	1.25

Charges for changes and additions

Charge group	Government / Central / State University	All other institutions
Change of site / location; Diploma-to-Degree conversion; start of each new Programme / Level; change in name of Trust / Society / Company; Merger of Institutions	0.25	3.50
Degree-to-Diploma conversion; Women's-to-Co-ed conversion and vice-versa; introduction or continuation of NRI seats; increase in Intake / additional Course(s); Integrated / Dual Degree	0.15	1.25
Change in name of Course; merger of Courses; reduction in Intake; closure of Programme / Course; change in name of Institution / affiliating University or Board; type of Institution converted into a University; address of Trust / Society / Company	0.10	0.60

Additional committee charges

Charge head	Government	All other
Additional Scrutiny / SHC / SAC (online or offline, including Court directions)	0.15	0.60
Additional EVC, online	0.25	1.25
Additional EVC, physical	0.50	2.50

Refund rules to encode: rejection at Scrutiny / Re-Scrutiny without appeal for Change of Site, Diploma/Degree conversion, new Programme / Level or Merger refunds the charge minus Rs 0.60 lakh (clause 2.3.2e). No TER for Postgraduate Degree courses other than MCA and Management, and for institutions applying under hibernation, and none where the State changes the University's jurisdiction or the course name is not offered by the University.

Table 2.1 was supplied as a rotated page image. The mapping of charge heads to the three change-and-addition columns should be checked against the official page before release.

8. Alerts, reminders and escalation

Every open task has an owner and a due date. The system warns the owner before the date and escalates up a fixed chain after it. Lead times and chain levels below are **proposed defaults** for AICTE to confirm; all are editable.

Escalation chain (default)

1. Level 0: the assigned committee member, expert or institution.
2. Level 1: the Regional officer for that Region.
3. Level 2: the Regulation Bureau officer.
4. Level 3: the designated senior authority (competent authority).

Trigger	Notified	Proposed timing	Escalates to
Application waiting at a stage near its processing limit	Assigned owner	70% and 90% of the stage limit	Level 1 at 100%, Level 2 at 125%
Application over its stage limit	Owner and Regional officer	Daily	Level 2, then Level 3

Trigger	Notified	Proposed timing	Escalates to
Application unassigned in a queue	Regional officer	After 1 working day	Level 2 after 3 days
Deficiency issued; compliance due	Institution	On issue, 7 days before, 2 days before, on due date	Regional officer on missed date
Compliance uploaded, awaiting verification	Scrutiny owner	On upload; daily if untouched	Level 1 after 3 days
EVC due to be scheduled (after scrutiny complete)	EVC coordinator	On entry to queue; weekly	Level 1, then Level 2 when over the limit
EVC scheduled	Institution, experts	On scheduling; 7 days, 2 days and 1 day before the visit	Level 1 if an expert declines or is absent
EVC report not uploaded	Expert	2 days after the visit; then daily	Level 1, then Level 2
Additional TER payment pending for EVC, SC, SHC or SAC	Institution	On request; every 3 days	Level 1 after 10 days
SHC or SAC hearing date	Institution, committee	7 days, 2 days and 1 day before	Level 1 if institution is absent
Speaking Order uploaded (appeal window opens)	Institution	On upload; day 3 and day 6 of 7	None; window closes on day 7
Security Deposit proof due (15 days)	Institution	Day 1, day 10, day 14; then at each penalty date (31 May, 31 July)	Regulation Bureau when approval is liable to be withdrawn
Student enrolment upload due	Institution	30 days, 7 days before 30 November	Regional officer after the date
Reopening or withdrawal request awaiting Competent Authority	Competent Authority	On request; every 2 days	Level 3

Rules

- Channels: in-app, email and SMS for institutions; in-app and email for officers. Channels and templates are configurable.
- Alerts count working days using a holiday calendar held in configuration.
- An alert stops when the task is closed, and every sent alert, acknowledgement and escalation is logged.
- Officers can snooze an alert once with a recorded reason; the system does not allow a second snooze.
- Each alert shows the application, the stage, the due date and a direct link to act.

9. Dashboards, reports and audit trail

Each role lands on a dashboard built for its next action. Every number drills down to the applications behind it.

Role	Dashboard shows	Key actions from it
Institution	Status of own application, current stage, next due date, open deficiencies, pending payments, orders	Upload compliance, pay, file appeal
Committee member / EVC expert	My queue, due dates, ageing, scheduled visits and hearings	Open checklist, record outcome, upload report
Regional officer	Region-wise pending by stage and ageing band, unassigned items, overdue list, workload per officer	Assign, reassign, nudge, escalate
Regulation Bureau officer	All Regions side by side, stage bottlenecks, EVC queue and completion, SHC / SAC cases, consolidated grant list	Compare Regions, build grant list, handle level-2 escalations
Executive Committee / SAC / Council	Cases for decision with full file, history and recommendations	Record decision, upload Speaking Order
Auditor	Read-only access to reports and audit trail	Export and review

Common metrics

- Applications by status: submitted, in scrutiny, in compliance, in EVC, at SHC, at Executive Committee, in appeal, granted, rejected, withdrawn.

- Ageing: days at current stage and total days since submission, in bands such as 0-7, 8-15, 16-30 and over 30 (configurable).
- Throughput: applications completed per stage per week, and average time per stage.
- Overdue and near-due counts by stage, Region and officer.
- EVC: queued, scheduled, completed and delayed; split online and physical.
- Compliance: deficiencies issued, closed, overdue.
- Rejections and returns by reason code.

Reports (export to PDF and spreadsheet)

1. Pendency report by Region, stage and category.
2. EVC status report.
3. Deficiency and compliance report.
4. Appeal and hearing report (SHC, SAC).
5. Security Deposit status report.
6. Overdue and escalation report.
7. Region-wise processing performance for each Academic Year.

Audit trail

The audit trail is append-only. Each entry stores:

- What happened: stage change, assignment, observation, return, decision, payment, alert, acknowledgement, escalation, closure, login to view a document.
- Who did it (user, role, Region) and when (timestamp, time zone).
- The application, stage and values before and after.
- The reason code and free-text reason where a reason is required.
- References to the documents involved, with a file hash, and to any session recording.
- A chained hash so that a changed or removed entry is detectable.

Authorised users can view the full history of one application as a single timeline, and export it with the hash check.

10. Data model, integrations and non-functional requirements

Core data entities

Entity	Key fields
Institution	PID, name, type (Govt / Central / State University / other), Region, affiliating University or Board, Trust / Society / Company, contacts
Application	Application ID, institution, Academic Year, one or more categories, route, current stage, submission time, TER status, cut-off flag
Application item (per category)	Category, route, per-category outcome, fallback flag
Stage instance	Stage type, owner or committee, opened, due, closed, result
Checklist and finding	Annexure-2 item, document link, result, remarks, verifier
Deficiency and compliance	Reason, issued date, due date, institution response, re-scrutiny result
EVC	Mode (online / physical), date, experts, report, additional fee status
Hearing and decision	SHC / SAC / Executive Committee / Council date, recommendation, Speaking Order, appeal clock
Payment	Head, amount, payment reference, status, refund / deduction
Security Deposit	Amount, intimation date, proof, Affidavit 3, penalty status
Alert and escalation	Trigger, recipient, channel, sent, acknowledged, level
Document	File, uploader, DSC status, hash, version
Audit event	Actor, action, before / after, reason, timestamp, chained hash
Rule and calendar	Routing table, timelines, fee table, Public Notice and Academic Calendar dates, holidays, effective dates

Integrations

System	Purpose	Approach
AICTE web portal	Source of applications, institution profiles, documents, student data; target for status, orders and approval letters	API or secure data sync; portal remains system of record for applications. To be confirmed (Section 11).
AICTE payment gateway	TER and penalty payment status	Status lookup or webhook
Digital Signature (DSC) verification	Validate DSC on uploaded documents	Verification service
Email and SMS gateways	Alerts to institutions and officers	Configurable providers
Identity and access	Sign-in, role mapping	AICTE single sign-on where available
Video-meeting platform	EVC and hearing recordings (clause 2.28)	Store reference link only

Non-functional requirements

- **Security:** role-based and Region-scoped access; encryption of data in transit and at rest; multi-factor sign-in for officers; every document view logged.
- **Confidentiality:** institution data visible only to authorised officials and the institution itself; committee conflict-of-interest blocking.
- **Accuracy of deadlines:** all clocks computed on a single server time in IST, with working-day and holiday calendars; a nightly check that recomputes every open clock.
- **Availability:** target of 99.5% during the application cycle; scheduled maintenance outside cut-off weeks.
- **Performance:** dashboards load in under 3 seconds for filtered views; alerts leave the system within 5 minutes of the trigger.
- **Scale:** sized for all institutions and applications in one cycle; AICTE to confirm volumes.
- **Auditability:** append-only audit log, retained as long as the approval record; export with integrity check.
- **Usability:** works on desktop and mobile browsers; English first, with room for Hindi labels.
- **Document storage:** secure object storage with versioning and virus scanning on upload.

- **Configurability:** no routing, fee or timeline value hard-coded.

11. Safeguards, success measures, prototype scope, risks and open questions

Regulatory safeguards

- The system works inside AICTE Regulations, the APH and authorised procedure. Alerts, recommendations and workflow moves support the process; they never replace scrutiny, verification, inspection or a decision by the competent authority.
- No stage can be marked complete, and no application approved, rejected or returned, without a named authorised user.
- Auto-generated text (case summaries, letters, deficiency drafts) is a draft that an authorised user must review and issue. The AI and OCR engine does not make approval decisions: it only extracts data and flags deterministic inconsistencies. Final authority for all document verification remains with the Scrutiny Committee.
- Fraud findings are flagged for the competent authority; the system takes no penal step itself.
- Rules can be changed only by administrators and only with a logged, dated version.

Success measures (proposed targets)

Measure	Target	How measured
Routing accuracy: applications sent to the correct stages	100% against Table 2.3 test cases	Test suite with one case per category
Alert timeliness: alerts sent within 5 minutes of trigger	99%	Alert log vs trigger time
Deadline reliability: clocks that match a manual recomputation	100%	Nightly reconciliation and sample audit
Visibility: open applications with a named owner and due date	100%	Dashboard query
Manual follow-up (calls, emails, reminders)	Down by at least half in one cycle	Officer survey and mailbox sample
Audit completeness: stage changes with a logged actor and reason	100%	Audit log check

Measure	Target	How measured
Missed appeal and deposit deadlines due to no reminder	Zero	Alert log vs deadline list

Prototype scope

The prototype demonstrates the following with seeded sample data:

1. Automatic routing for at least four categories (one SD, one SCR, one SCR+EVC+AA such as Increase in Intake, and Change of Site), with Change of Site / Location built out in full. That flow ingests a public AICTE EoA letter as the master record, plus a synthetic Format-2 NOC and Format-3 Resolution (both labelled synthetic), and shows OCR extraction, three-value edit detection and cross-document rule checks before the file reaches the Scrutiny queue.
2. Role-based dashboards for Institution, Scrutiny member, Regional officer and Regulation Bureau.
3. Scrutiny with checklist, the split-screen evidence review, officer dispositions, deficiency, compliance upload and Re-Scrutiny.
4. EVC queue, scheduling and reminder alerts.
5. SHC and Executive Committee decision with Speaking Order, then the 7-day appeal clock and SAC.
6. Return / revert with reason, one-time reopening, and fallback to EoA.
7. Security Deposit 15-day clock with penalty dates.
8. Overdue case escalation up the chain.
9. The complete audit trail of one application, with hash check.

Delivery phases

Phase	Content
Prototype	Items above, on sample data, with a stubbed portal feed
Release 1 (P0)	Live portal integration, all P0 requirements, role-based access, reports
Release 2 (P1)	P1 requirements, extended alert channels, EVC post-approval tracking

Phase	Content
Phase 2 modules	Time-bound undertakings, lease and document validity monitoring (problem statement sections D and E)

Risks

Risk	Mitigation
APH rules change mid-cycle	Rules held as dated configuration; admin console; regression tests per category
Portal data cannot be shared in real time	Scheduled sync with clear "as of" time on every screen
Alert fatigue for officers	Digest option, snooze once with reason, escalation only past due date
Incorrect fee or deadline value configured	Four-eyes approval for rule changes; preview of effect before publishing
Over-reliance on automation	Mandatory human sign-off on every decision; drafts labelled as such

Open questions for AICTE

1. What are the target days for Scrutiny, Re-Scrutiny, EVC scheduling, SHC and Executive Committee action? The pasted text gives none.
2. How is Introduction of Off-Campus routed? Clause 2.11e says it is processed like a New Technical Institution, and it has no row in Table 2.3.
3. Does Extended EoA (listed in Table 2.2 as Year round) follow the SCR route, and what are its documents?
4. Which roles may add a random EVC (clause 2.3.5) and approve a one-time reopening (clause 2.3.3e)?
5. Who is the designated authority at each escalation level, by Region?
6. Can the portal expose APIs, or must the platform read from a data export?
7. The Table 2.1 columns for "change and addition" charges were read from a rotated image. Please confirm the mapping.
8. Which APH sections beyond Chapter II (1.8 Scrutiny, 1.9 EVC) and which Annexure-2 lists should be loaded into the checklist engine first?

12. Standing out: alignment with PS 26262 and demo plan

The problem statement lists how the prototype will be judged. The plan is to make each of those points visible on screen, then add the AI layer as the memorable part, built on top of a workflow that is already correct. A weak workflow under a strong AI demo would lose on the stated criteria.

Evaluation criteria and proof on screen

PS evaluation criterion	What the prototype shows	Proof the judge can see
Workflow accuracy	Every category routes as Table 2.3 says	A test scoreboard with one automated test for each of the 21 rows of Table 2.3, all passing
Timeliness of alerts	Reminders fire at the configured lead times	A demo clock: advance time and watch the alert log fill, then escalate
Reliability of deadline tracking	The 7-day appeal and 15-day Security Deposit clocks are exact	A nightly reconciliation report that recomputes every open clock and shows zero differences
Visibility of pending cases	Role-based dashboards by Region, stage and ageing	Drill-down from any count to the applications behind it
Reduction in manual follow-up	Reminders, escalation and the AI pre-check replace calls and back-and-forth	A before / after table of manual steps for one case
Completeness of the audit trail	Every action, alert, edit and officer disposition is logged	A tamper test: change one stored row and the hash check fails

The prototype list in the PS, item by item

The PS says the prototype should show eight things. This PRD puts undertakings and lease monitoring in a later phase, but a judge will read the list literally. The prototype therefore includes a thin slice of each, reusing the alert engine and the OCR layer.

PS prototype item	Covered by	Prototype plan
Automated application routing	Section 4 and 5	Full: Table 2.3 routing engine

PS prototype item	Covered by	Prototype plan
Role-based dashboards	Section 9	Full: four roles
Stage-wise pendency monitoring	Section 9	Full
EVC alerts	Section 8	Full: queue, schedule, reminders
Escalation of overdue cases	Section 8	Full: three levels with the demo clock
Compliance submission tracking	Deficiency compliance cycle	Full for deficiency compliance
Undertaking tracking	Security Deposit proof and Affidavit 3 (clause 2.25f)	Thin slice: one undertaking record with due date, evidence upload, officer verification and reminders. The full tracker is Phase 2.
Lease / document expiry monitoring	Lease end date read by the AI layer; RULE-LEASE-01	Thin slice: one lease with advance and overdue alerts. The full monitor is Phase 2.

What makes this different

1. **Rules as data, each with its clause.** Routing, fees, deadlines and checks live in a registry that an administrator edits. A judge can change a deadline and watch the alerts move, with no code change.
2. **Evidence, not opinion.** Every finding shows the rule, the APH clause, both values and the highlighted words on the original document. Nothing is a bare "looks fine".
3. **Three-value edit detection.** The system keeps what the document says, what the institution claims and what AICTE's record says, so a quiet edit is visible and cannot clear a failed rule.
4. **The AI reads; people decide.** This matches the PS Regulatory Safeguard word for word: automated checks support the process and never replace scrutiny, verification or the competent authority's decision.
5. **A demo clock.** Deadlines are the heart of the PS. A control that moves time forward lets the judges see reminders, overdue alerts and escalations without waiting days.
6. **Tamper-evident audit trail.** The hash chain is shown failing when a record is changed.
7. **Conformance tests shown, not claimed.** The Table 2.3 scoreboard turns "we followed the handbook" into something checkable.

8. **Honest limits.** The open questions and the AI risks are in the document. Judges tend to trust a team that names what it does not know.

Five-minute demo script

1. **Regional officer dashboard.** Pending cases by stage and ageing, with near-due and overdue counts.
2. **Institution uploads a Change of Site pack.** The EoA is the master record; the NOC and Resolution are read by OCR and the form is auto-filled.
3. **The institution edits one field.** It turns amber with the badge "Institution edited AI extraction".
4. **Rules fire.** One address mismatch and one "partial shifting" phrase in the Resolution appear as red findings with their clauses.
5. **Officer split-screen.** Clicking a finding highlights the words on the PDF; the officer confirms one finding and dismisses another with a reason.
6. **Routing.** The application moves to the EVC queue; a second EVC is scheduled after the shift (clause 2.17e).
7. **Demo clock.** Advance time: reminders go out, an overdue case escalates from officer to Regional officer to Bureau.
8. **Decision, appeal and deposit clocks.** The Speaking Order starts the 7-day appeal window; the grant starts the 15-day Security Deposit clock.
9. **Audit trail.** Show the full timeline, then the tamper test.
10. **Admin console.** Change one deadline and show the alert timing change.

Build order if time is short

1. Routing engine with the Table 2.3 test scoreboard.
2. Clocks, alerts, escalation and the demo clock.
3. Role dashboards.
4. AI pre-check for Change of Site, with the split-screen review.
5. Audit trail with hash check.
6. Lease and undertaking thin slices.
7. Admin console and reports.

Demo data rules

- Use only a publicly available AICTE EoA letter as the master record, and note that its edition may use an older format than the 2024-27 APH.

- Label every Format-2 NOC and Format-3 Resolution you create as synthetic, and do not present it as a real institution's document.
- Keep the external model fallback off for any document that is not public or synthetic.